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May the Best Man Win

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"Winning Rounds Since 2000"

(Ben, a generic late 20-something year old man, walks towards the front door of his father's house, guiding his girlfriend Amy towards the front door.)

Ben: Stop worrying, everything's gonna be fine! Believe it or not, you're the first girlfriend I've introduced to my dad since...well…
Amy: ...Ever?
Ben: Yeah. So, the bar is so low that it doesn't even exist!
Amy: Okay, I believe the part about you not having girlfriends, but I don't know...It's Thanksgiving! What if your dad hates me?
Ben: He's not going to hate you, just watch. A few minutes from now, I bet he'll already be in love with you.
(He opens the door and calls out.)
Ben: Dad! We're here!
(A loose pile jolts awake in a living room chair—it's Ben's dad.)
Dad: Huh? Who's there?! Burglars?!
Ben: No dad, it's me Ben! And my girlfriend Amy!
Amy: Hi Mr. Aldridge!
Dad: *(waking up)* You said...that...that that's...Amy? Oh god, what a disgusting name.
Ben: Dad!
Dad: Just kidding! It's beautiful, just like you. *(stands, now energetic)* Hi, I'm Harry, welcome to my humble abode...
Amy: Oh. Well, thank you! I don't think it's so humble. This is probably one of the better abodes I've been in!
(Amy laughs. Dad picks up on it, even louder.)
Dad: Oh Amy you are a real hoot. Come on in, take a seat! Close to me, please. *(pulls a chair)* There ya go.
(They all sit around the Thanksgiving dinner table.)
Ben: Wow Dad. You know, when we first came in here I thought you were gonna act all weird today, but--
Dad: What? Me? Weird? No, no no no, just wanted to play a little joke like I was all sleeping over there. Nailed it. So, anyway, Amy...how long have you two been dating?
Amy: Oh. Well, I guess officially we've been together for...almost a year now?
Dad: I see, I see. And what is it that you do?
Amy: I'm actually a grad student, I'm in my first year of--
Dad: Wow, wow wow. That's so interesting. And did you know that Ben can't bench press a hundred pounds?
Ben: Uh…okay Dad, funny.
Dad: Because I can bench press at least like...a hundred and ten. So...
Amy: Um…I'm not sure I get what you're getting at...
Dad: Does Ben even have a bench to press?
Ben: Dad, what are you doing?
Dad: *(flexes)* Come on. Look at that muscle and honestly say you wouldn't rather be dating me.
Amy: Um…
Ben: DAD!

Dad: Eh? I mean, yeah.
Amy: Well...you were right about your dad loving me!...

(Ben sits across from his spaced out friend Percival in Percy's living room.)

Ben: *(mid-conversation)* So, yeah. Do you think you could do that for me? I'm only in town for a few days and you're one of the only people I'm still friends with. Plus I can't really ask my dad because...uh, he's got a bad back...
Percival: Oh totally Ben-friend, I got'ch'er back! Ha, not your dad's back though! Because you said that it is whack, so I don't want his back.
(Percial initiates an intricate and bro-y handshake.)
Ben: Oh! We're doing this, okay…
(Doorbell.)
Percival: Whoa whoa bro, who's at my do'?!
Dad: *(entering)* Knock knock my Brosef Stalins! What's good in the hood!
Percival: Ah man, I'm all out of rhymes.
Ben: Dad??
Dad: Ooh, did I miss out on a *handshake*?! Let me get in on that goodness, yo! *(he smacks his hands wildly)* Huh? YOLO swaaag, up-five!
Ben: High-five, Dad. It's called a high-five, everybody who has ever existed knows--nevermind. What the hell are you doing here?!
Dad: Whaaat? Why wouldn't I be hanging out with my peeps! You're my boys, ...boys! Chad, how are things? Huh? Things be ballin, Chad?
Percival: My name is Percival, dude.
Dad: Oh...Alright, *Percival*. Good catchin' up with ya. And now that we've played catch-up, why don't we play catch! Ben-jammin', go deep!
(Dad pulls out a football, bounces around like he's Peyton Manning or something.)
Ben: Dad, I'm 28 years old. I stopped going deep...forever ago.
Dad: Oh. Well...think fast, butthead!
(He whips the football at Ben's head.)
Ben: Ow! Did you just call me a butthead?!
Percival: Yo, what's wrong with your dad though, brah?
Dad: Whoa. Percival. Not cool bro. Thought we were bros, bro.
Ben: Dad, Percival's right! There's something seriously wrong with you, and I say that completely out of love. The kind of love that has experienced a lifetime of you trying to one-up me at everything I do!
Dad: What?! When have I *ever* done that!
Ben: Well, today. Twice, actually, and it's not even four--
Dad: Okay, yeah, but...when else?!
Ben: Oh, I don't know. How about, every day in elementary school…

(Flashback to a first grade classroom. A mustached teacher lifts a giant orange ball.)
Teacher: Okay class, this is the sun. Ain't that neat? Big ole' ball of light that toasts us up like the fireplace of our solar system that we just wiggle our toes by on a cold winter's eve. Now...Ben! Do you know exactly how the sun gets itself all hot and toasty?

Little Ben: Uhm...no.
Dad: *(from nearby desk)* HA! This idiot's' such an idiot, let's all laugh at him! Hey, where's the idiot? Oh look, look there he is! Found him! I found the idiot!
Little Ben: Dad?!
Dad: Whoa, don't call me that here. I don't want them to know we're related.
Little Ben: I...I...Why are you doing this to me?
Dad: Hey hey hey, whoa whoa. Whoa. Don't blame me for you getting the question wrong.

(Back to the present...)
Ben: Remember?
Dad: Okay, yeah, sure, but that was one--
Ben: Or when I was taking my driving test…

(Flashback to teen Ben tightly gripping the steering wheel.)
Ben: Alright. I'm taking a left turn at this intersection…
Dad: *(popping out)* Backseat driver surprise!!!!

(Dad rips the steering wheel all the way to the right.)
Ben: AH, Dad no we're going to crash!!!
Dad: But it'll be such a funny story!!!

(Back to the present.)
Ben: Then there was also that time--
Dad: Okay okay you can stop listing examples of awesome parenting. I mean, I know you're not quite as bright as me, but this theory of yours is just bull-noogy! That's right, I said. Bull-noogy.
Ben: AghhhAHH! Look Dad, I need to be alone for a little while, okay? Please. Don't follow me.
Dad: But…
Ben: Percival, meet you at that place for that thing we discussed?
Percival: Uh...what? Oh, yeah! You're talking about when I'm going to help you pr--
Ben: Shhh, Percival!
(Ben storms out.)
Dad: Thank god he's gone.
(Percival stares at him for a moment. Dad gets the hint, walks out.)

(Ben walks Amy along a trail next to a beautiful lake.)
Ben: Believe it or not, I caught my first fish right over there. Unfortunately, it also caught me. By the shorts. And that was the day half the world saw my bottom half.
Amy: I'm surprised your dad didn't try to out-flash you or something.
Ben: Oh...but he did. But. He did...
Amy: Hey...isn't that your friend in the water? Uh...what's his name?
Ben: Percival?!
Percival: Hey bro!
(We see Percival standing in water that doesn't even go up to his waist.)
Amy: It looks like he's in trouble!

Percival: I uh, I need your help man! I'm going under, I can't breathe, man!
(He slaps at the water, tries dipping his body under, does an overall poor job of pretending he's drowning.)
Amy: Somebody save him!
Ben: Don't worry Percival, I'm coming!
(Ben rushes, yanks him out of the lake and drags his heavy body onto the shore.)
Ben: Holy crap dude, stop eating so many Cheetos.
Percival: Never!
Amy: You saved him!
Ben: Yeah. And it was such a close call...
Amy: Oh wait, look! Something just fell off of him!
Ben: Yeah, I thought I saw something...let me see...oh. There it is.

(Ben kneels, finds the object. It's a ring case. He turns to face Amy on one knee.)
Ben: Amy Drackledorf-McHam....would you make me the happiest man in the world and be my--dad is here?!?!
Dad: Yeah he is!
Ben: What the hell Dad?! How did you find me?!
Dad: Benjamin Rockem Sockem Smith, you are proposing to your girlfriend, do you think I would miss this for the world?
Percival: *(eating popcorn, watching excitedly)* I know I wouldn't!
Dad: See? Chad catches my drift.
Percival: My name's Perciv--UGH!

(Percival gulps, but something's wrong. His throat is lodged! He grabs at it, screaming muffled, unintelligible words.)
Amy: Oh my god, he's choking! Somebody help!
Dad: I've got it I've got it, hold your horses. Now Percy, I'm gonna have to get uncomfortably close to your backside for this…
Percival: MM?!?!
Dad: Come here Perce.. *(gets in Heimlich formation)* Releasing obstruction in three...two...one!
(With a big pull into Percy's stomach, Percival coughs out a big lodged projectile.)
Percy: Oh my god, thank you! Oh thank you thank you thank you! Bro for life, man! Bros for life!!!
(They perform and intricate handshake.)
Amy: Oh my gosh I can't believe you saved him!
Dad: Oh believe it pretty mama. Now, let's just see what caused the problem…*(looking)* Oh. There it is…funny, it was a ring!

(He kneels, turning to Amy with a ring in his hands.)
Amy...ever since I met you earlier today, when my son brought you home, I haven't been able to get you out of my mind. Would you do me the honors of becoming my wife? Please? *(looks)* Benjamin...why are you charging at me with that trash barrel raised above your head?
Ben: *(charging)* AGHHH I'M GOING TO KILL YOU!!!

Amy: Wait wait stop! There's got to be a more reasonable way to fix this without resorting to Donkey Kong levels of violence, okay? So just put down the barrel and talk to your father...*(whispered)* who clearly needs some help...

(Ben stops, reluctantly lowers the barrel.)
Ben: Yeah, yeah you're right. Look Dad...you can't keep trying to steal my thunder with everything I do. This was supposed to be the happiest moment of my life and you just had to come in and take it for yourself.
Dad: Oh Ben...Benny Ben Ben ben, I didn't know you felt that way! I'm not trying to take your life, I've just been...I don't know. I just wanted to be close to you. You know, you're probably too young to remember it, but after your mother passed, well…I guess I got a little lonely. Pretty lonely, actually. I guess all these years I was just trying to show you that I could be just like you...maybe make you want to hang out with me more. Dumb, I know. *So* me, l.m.f.a.o.r.o.f.l.o.l.
Ben: Aw, Dad, that's not dumb at all. I'm sorry I didn't realize. Look, let's hang out more, okay? I'll visit as much as I can.
Dad: You mean it?
Ben: Absolutely. And we can have our own secret handshakes too.
Dad: Ooh, yes! What about this one, huh?
(Smacks Ben hard in the hands.)
Ben: OW! Stop!
Dad: Sorry!
Ben: And Dad, if you don't mind…*(turning)* Amy…
Amy: Yes of course! Yes yes yes!!

(She flails, hugs Ben with unyielding excitement.)
Dad: I'm always the bridesmaid, never the bride.
Ben: Well Dad, I am gonna need a best man…
Percival: And I will gladly accept your generous nomination--
Ben: Percival. I want my dad to do it.
Percival: Oh. Okay then guess I drowned and choked for nothing!
Dad: You...you want, I...me...the best, of men…
Ben: So, what do you say?
Dad: I say...that means I must be better than you, so I'm the best. Thank you! I win.
Ben: It's not a competition, Dad--
Dad: But I won? Or…
Ben: *We* won.
(They bump knuckles up, down,, finish the handshake with an explosion.)
Dad: Bros for life?
Ben: Bros for life.